never tell a lie, use the sacred name irreverently, nor mock the aged or deformed.

"'That when a stranger speaks to them they give a modest, audible answer, standing up, and with their faces turned towards him.

"'That they observe a sober and becoming behaviour when going to, coming from, and in religious meetings.

"'That their whole conduct and conversation be dutiful to their masters, and kind and affectionate to their schoolfellows, and that in all cases they observe the command of Christ, "All things whatsoever ye would that men should do unto you, do ye even so to them."

"'That in the evening they collect themselves and take their seats in the dining-room, and after answering to their names when called over, and attending to such parts of the Holy Scriptures and other religious books, which may be read to them, they retire to their bedchambers, and undress with as much stillness as possible, folding up their clothes neatly, and putting them in their proper places; and they are tenderly advised to close, as well as to begin the day, with the remembrance of their gracious Creator, whose mercies are over all His works.'"

"The instructions to schoolmistresses; being similar to those for schoolmasters; and the general rules being nearly the same for girls, I omit copying them.

"I cannot better conclude this subject than in the words of my learned, much respected and honoured friend Dr. Price. 'Seminaries of learning are the springs of society, which, as they flow foul or pure, diffuse through successive generations depravity and misery, or on the contrary, virtue and happiness. On the bent given to our minds as they open and expand, depends their subsequent fate; and on the general management of education depend the honour and dignity of our species.'"

[From *An Account of Lazarettos*, pp. 118–124.]

HULKS ON THE THAMES

In my first edition (p. 75), I passed some censures on the management of convicts committed to hard labour on the Thames; and in a subsequent visit I was still more convinced of the faults I had observed. The effects of these became so alarming, as to attract the notice of Parliament. A public inquiry was instituted, by which it appeared, that from August 1776, when the convicts were first put on board the *Justitia*, to 26 March, 1778, out of six hundred and thirty-two prisoners who had

been received, one hundred and seventy-six had died. It is with pleasure that I can give an account, which will show in a striking light the beneficial effects of this parliamentary inquiry as to the health of the prisoners, and the obligations the public were under to the committee appointed on this occasion, and particularly to its chairman, Sir Charles Bunbury.

At my visit, 16 November, 1779, there were at Woolwich, for the reception of convicts, an old Indiaman, called the *Justitia*; and a frigate, the *Censor*. In the former were two hundred and fifty-six; and in the latter, two hundred and fifty. That which was first called the *Justitia*, is converted into a hospital ship, in which were twenty patients. Another, called the *Reception*, was empty: in this, convicts were examined by the surgeon, and continued three days, before they were sent either to the hulks, or to the hospital ship.

The prisoners on board the *Justitia* looked healthy and well; the decks were clean. They had bedding; their provisions were good of the sort; and there were not any (as at my former visits) without shoes and stockings. I found the *Censor*, below deck, cleaner than the *Justitia*; yet, on carefully viewing the convicts, they had not so healthy and contented an aspect as those in the other; and a much greater proportion of this ship's company was sent to the hospital. This created in me a suspicion that something was wrong. I examined all their provisions, bedding, etc., and found that they were the same as on board the *Justitia*. It would be highly proper that a table of their stated allowance should be hung up, and scales, weights, and measures assigned them, to check the pursers who give out their provision. In the hospital ship, on the two decks (one of which is for recovering patients) were twenty-five cradles, but smaller than those in the Royal Hospitals at Haslar and Plymouth, where all lie single. Of the few who were very sick, I found their irons were off. The cleanliness and quietness of the hospital did honour to the conductor. It is to be wished that the patients had better nourishment, as that in many cases would be more salutary than medical prescriptions.

There were about one hundred and fifty at work in the warren in 1779; most of them clothed in a brown uniform. I observed that the situation of these unhappy people was altered for the better. Yet their bread allowance of one pound a day was too little, especially for those who worked, although they had an extra allowance of beer.

"At both my visits, the hulks were clean, the bread good, the